minister of the local Disciples of Christ church. She was packing for a trip to a distant town in rural Illinois where she'd been lucky enough to find a teaching job.

We had a sad parting, but knew that with things getting worse every day, separations were inevitable in the Depression. We both had to take jobs wherever we could find them.

When I went on to Chicago, I met rejection everywhere I went. When I suggested I wanted to become a radio announcer (I never mentioned my real goal of becoming a *sports* announcer), I was practically laughed out the door, usually without even an interview. The only encouragement I got was from the program director of the NBC station in Chicago. A kind woman, she heard my appeal for a job, then told me I was in the wrong place. "In Chicago," she said, "we can't afford to take people without experience. You've got every reason to try for a job in radio, but first go out to what we call 'the sticks.' You'll find someone who'll take you on and give you experience; then one day, you can come to Chicago."

Discouraged, I hitchhiked back to Dixon in the rain. By this time my summer earnings were almost gone and I needed a job of any kind. Then, several days later, after my hopes had soared, I lost the job at Montgomery Ward.